THE BURGESS PERSIAN LETTERS[1]

Edited by BENJAMIN SCHWARTZ

APPENDIX

INTERVIEW WITH ANNA [Mrs. Edward] BURGESS[2]

MY ancestors, on the sides of both parents, were Armenians, and I think for some time have lived in Tabriz. My father, Daoud Khan Seguinoff, was always in the military service of the Shah of Persia. My dear mother died some time before him. My uncles were men in high position. We were six in family, two brothers and four sisters. Both of my brothers were merchants in Tabreez; both are now dead. I am the eldest of the sisters. My next sister is the widow of Aga Pedros, an Armenian merchant. She lives in Tehràn, and has three sons. My youngest sister, Tamar, is the widow of Dr. Cormick. Dr. Cormick's father came to Persia to be on the medical staff of the Shah. He married an Armenian lady, and Dr. C. was born in Tabriz . . .

We had known Charles and Edward Burgess a long time. They were merchants of china, guns, and many other things, and went to and fro between Tabriz and Tehràn. Edward Burgess asked for me of my father. I loved him even before we were married. Then we were married at my father's house . . .

When my husband was appointed to superintend the printing of the Government newspaper in Tehràn, we got a few things needful for our house, and then our little son John was born. Mr. Ronald Thompson was his Godfather (as he was afterwards for our daughter Fanny). Both of our children were baptized in our house in Tehràn, according to the Armenian rites. And the priests said they registered the times, but I am not very sure about them, for those gentlemen neglect to do it at the very same time, and it is said they often make mistakes.

[1] In addition to the Burgess letters, Mrs. Thomas F. Burgess' gift included a printed . . . *Notice respecting the Trade of the Northern Provinces of Persia, addressed to T. H. Villiers, Esq. by C. H. Burgess,* probably written in 1832, and manuscript copies, in Charles Burgess' hand, of his memoranda on the state of trade and political conditions in Persia written, in 1833, to the Duke of Richmond and, in 1835, to Lord Ponsonby. Neither of the latter has been printed, so far as the Library can discover, but there seems hardly enough more information in them, or in the Villiers *Notice,* than is given in the *Letters,* to warrant publication here. T. H. Villiers, to whom the *Notice* was addressed, was a Member of Parliament, and had been in the colonial office. The *Notice,* though printed in the customary form, was not included among the Parliamentary Papers. Mr. Villiers' death in 1832, presumably the date of the *Notice,* may account for the omission, since it may have been printed too late for him to present it to Parliament.

The printed *Notice,* and the manuscripts and transcripts of the other memoranda, together with the original letters are, of course, available in the Library.

[2] The manuscript of this interview, of which a portion is printed here, is dated "C. Belmont Villas. Leicester. March, 1880."

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